

Virtual Reality

Sony Labs have devised Transticks—removable media that act as a virtual wire and as a shared memory card. The virtual wire can be used to connect laptops to slide projectors, while the cards will allow two computers to share memory on a server.



A Video iPod

UK mobile supplier Peripheral Corner has launched “Swiss Army Knife of gadgets”—a portable video player with a hard disk. It has 40 GB, ready for MP3, MPEG 4 video and JPEG pictures, which are downloaded from a PC via USB 2.0.



Illustration: Anil Deshmukh

Enter

Geet Sethi Sportsman

Geet Sethi, six-time world billiards champion, Padma Shri, Arjuna Award winner, national snooker champ, and founder of sports portal, *Khiladi.com*, speaks to *Digit* on technology, technology, and well, more technology.

What does technology mean to you?

Technology speeds up communication and eases work. Gadgets help simplify and streamline lots of activities.

Is technology only for geeks?

Technology touches every part of our life—transport, communication, even in mundane services like booking tickets online. We will be wrong to say technology is for geeks only.

And how do you use it everyday?

For communication, mainly. I use my Palm Tungsten T for e-mail. I use my Bluetooth-enabled mobile phone for easier communication, and my Sony Vaio notebook. I use the laptop to write columns. At home I use audio-video systems. Not to forget, my laptop!

What gadgets do you usually buy?

I'm interested in PCs, audio systems, and MP3 players. I think the Apple iPod is beautiful.

Do you keep up with latest tech trends?

I read lots of foreign magazines like *Fortune*. Sometimes keeping up to date is difficult especially if you play lots of events on the professional circuit.

WEB BATTLES

War of the Searches

Politics makes for strange bedfellows. So do e-mail and search wars.

Take Yahoo! and Google. Until a year ago, both were best of pals, with Yahoo! even being a long-time investor in Google.

Back in 2002, Yahoo! took on Google as its partner to power its search. In February 2004, the two companies parted ways: Yahoo! began to test its own search engine.

And recently, Google launched Gmail, starting off the e-mail-storage domino-effect.

Then, in July, Google acquired Picasa, an online photo-management

company that makes software for organising digital photos. In May this year, Picasa's technologies were integrated into the Blogger service of Google, in order to help simplify the process of publishing and sharing of digital images within the context of Blogger.

The latest is that Yahoo! has acquired Oddpost Inc., a startup that has “gained the reputation for making it easier and more enticing

to communicate on the Web,” according to MIT's *technologyreview.com*. And according to *internetweek.com*, “Oddpost technology will play an

important role in developing of the next generation Yahoo! Mail.”

Yahoo! spokesperson Mary Osako said in an official statement, “The acquisition of Oddpost provides Yahoo! with outstanding technological expertise, which will be brought to bear on products across the Yahoo! network, such as Yahoo! Mail.”

So why did Yahoo! want Oddpost? Oddpost's application provides regular e-mail, photo sharing, and news feed aggregation. The application functions like a desktop application without the need to continually refresh pages, through a combination of DHTML, XML, and JavaScript. The application remains accessible from any location. Ostensibly, the new Yahoo e-mail service

With Google taking over Picasa and Yahoo! acquiring Oddpost, the two giants are ready for a face off



Illustrations: Manish Benkar